

Transfer Learning in Commodity Forecasting

Master Thesis Defense

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- 1 Motivation and Research Question
- 2 Literature and Contribution
- 3 Data and Methodology
- 4 Results
- 5 Robustness and Discussion
- 6 Conclusion

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- ▶ Explain the real-world or academic problem.
- ▶ Why does this question matter?
- ▶ What gap motivates your thesis?

Key takeaway

Summarize the core motivation in one sentence.

Question

What is the main research question of your thesis?

- ▶ Define the key concepts.
- ▶ State the expected contribution.
- ▶ Briefly preview your approach.

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- ▶ Literature stream 1: key papers and findings.
- ▶ Literature stream 2: key papers and findings.
- ▶ Literature stream 3: unresolved gap.

Biodiversity loss is emerging as a material risk factor for financial markets, alongside the more familiar climate-change channel.

The paper by Guidolin and Pedio (Review of Finance, 2062) asks a sharp question:

Question

Do commodity markets price biodiversity-related transition risk? Do commodities with higher biodiversity exposure command a risk premium, and do they react differently to binding policy news?

The mechanism operates through two channels.

- ▶ **Normal times:** higher biodiversity intensity: greater regulatory and reputational exposure: higher required excess return (risk premium).
- ▶ **Around the Kunming Declaration (Oct 2021):** the event raises the salience of biodiversity transition risk, triggering a negative price revision for high-intensity commodities — to allow for larger future returns..

- ▶ Contribution 1.
- ▶ Contribution 2.
- ▶ Contribution 3.

Key takeaway

Your thesis contributes by doing X, using Y, and showing Z.

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- ▶ Data source: describe where your data comes from.
- ▶ Sample period: state the time range.
- ▶ Unit of observation: firm, individual, country, transaction, etc.
- ▶ Final sample size: number of observations.

You can write your main empirical specification here:

$$Y_{it} = \alpha + \beta X_{it} + \gamma Z_{it} + \mu_i + \lambda_t + \varepsilon_{it}$$

- ▶ Y_{it} : outcome variable.
- ▶ X_{it} : main explanatory variable.
- ▶ Z_{it} : controls.
- ▶ μ_i and λ_t : fixed effects.

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	Model 1	Model 2	Model 3
Main variable	0.123**	0.115**	0.109*
Controls	No	Yes	Yes
Fixed effects	No	No	Yes
Observations	1,000	1,000	1,000

Table 1: Main regression results

Source: Author's calculations

- ▶ Explain the sign of the coefficient.
- ▶ Explain the economic magnitude.
- ▶ Explain statistical significance.
- ▶ Connect the result back to your research question.

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- ▶ Alternative specification.
- ▶ Alternative sample.
- ▶ Alternative variable definition.
- ▶ Placebo or falsification test.

Key takeaway

The main result remains stable across robustness checks.

- ▶ Limitation 1.
- ▶ Limitation 2.
- ▶ Limitation 3.

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- ▶ Restate the research question.
- ▶ Summarize the main finding.
- ▶ Explain the contribution.
- ▶ Mention implications or future research.

Thank you.

Questions?

7 Appendix

Additional Results

Put extra tables, figures, or robustness checks here.

Variable	Definition
Y	Outcome variable
X	Main explanatory variable
Z	Control variables

Table 2: Variable definitions